

# Brentwood Management Move Policy 2025 - 2030

**A Thriving & Growing Economy**  
**Cleaner, Greener and Safer**  
**A Place to Call Home**  
**A leading Local Authority**

## Introduction

A management move is where a high priority transfer status is given to a council tenant of a Housing Revenue Account (HRA) property because of the tenant's exceptional circumstances which requires the tenant to move urgently out of their home or the area.

## Purpose

This policy sets out the Council's approach to managing emergency situations where tenants are unable to remain living in their homes for a period or who may require urgent permanent re-housing in specific circumstances.

This policy outlines our approach to letting the Council's Housing Revenue Account (HRA) properties only in cases of a management move.

This policy does not cover temporary moves or decants that occur where the tenant returns to the same property and relates to the implementation of permanent moves only.

This policy should be read and applied in conjunction with the Lettings Policy.

## Criteria for a Management Move

When letting the Council's homes it is the aim to house those in greatest need of housing. The Council recognises that there will be exceptional situations where tenants may require urgent re-housing in specific circumstances.



Agreeing to a management move is exceptional, as the decision overrides the Choice Based Lettings process and as a result delays the rehousing of other applicants on the transfer list and housing register who may also have high needs.

There is also a cost to the housing service, as each transfer will result in void charges, staff time and administrative costs. The circumstances of the applicant will therefore need to be extremely serious to justify a management move.



The Council will consider every case on its individual merits, and ensure the approach is reasonable and effectively controlled and monitored.

The following circumstances are where a management transfer would apply:

**Threats to life and limb:** A threat to life or limb occurs when a tenant, or member of the tenant's family (who lives at the same address), is the victim of a threat of physical harm.

A threat would be considered where it can be demonstrated that perpetrators have been physically engaged in actions aimed at causing personal injury to either the tenant or other persons residing with them and that a move is required. This can include physical damage to their property or belongings. In deciding if the threat is credible, we will consider any current or previous actions or patterns of behaviour displayed by the perpetrators.

We will also consider where there is a continuous and escalating pattern of more severe threats to the tenant. In these situations, the combination of all previous incidents suggest that a serious threat, assault or other forms of physical harm is more likely to be carried out against the tenant or one or more members of the tenant's family who live at the same address.

Examples of this would include anti-social behaviour and domestic abuse. One isolated incident may not be considered reason for a move, however, these cases will be considered case by case.



**Properties in need of major work:** This is when a property is in need of major work that cannot be reasonably carried out with the tenant in occupation, where the works are expected to exceed 6 months or the property needs to be sold or converted to a different use. The tenant's individual circumstances will determine whether they could be expected to occupy the premises whilst the works are carried out in accordance with the Council's Decant Policy.





## Offer of a Management Move

If a permanent management move is agreed by the Council, only one reasonable offer will be made.

Usually this will be anywhere in the Borough considered safe and for this to be for the same type and size of accommodation that the tenancy covers. Any variation to the existing size of property will need to be justified and based on appropriate evidence. Where the current property is larger than your current needs you may be asked to move to a smaller property and any incentives available for downsizing may apply.

Only 1 in every 3 void properties are available to management moves as we must ensure properties are still available for transfers and housing register/homeless applicants.

When deciding what areas are deemed safe, this must be supported by evidence and recommendations based on risk from a medical professional, police officer or other relevant authority.

Out of borough moves may be required where the risk of violence is deemed severe or where the perpetrator resides in the Borough. These decisions will need to be supported by appropriate evidence.

Evidence which may be requested from you to support any management move request includes, but is not limited to;

- Supporting pro-forma from a police officer based on risk level of your case
- Police incident logs including details of the events of each case
- Supporting letter from a medical professional detailing the facts of any illnesses and how they affect your housing or how your housing affects the illness.

Not all cases will require a management move. The Panel may deem that it is suitable, with the correct evidence provided to award additional



points on the transfer register. This will allow applicants to bid on their desired properties in an area of their choice and would not be subject to a one time offer. If this decision is made by the panel, you will be notified in writing and may need to provide further supporting evidence in line with our allocations policy.



## Decisions and Appeals

All cases will be presented and heard at our Tenancy Changes Panel where a decision will be made by the Chair of the panel based on evidence provided at the time.

If you are unsatisfied with the outcome decision, you can appeal this in writing within 28 days of the decision being notified to you.

This will be heard by a Corporate Manager or above, who did not attend the original meeting where the decision was made.

The appeals officer decision is final and any escalations must be submitted through our formal complaints procedure.

## Review of this policy

This policy and procedure will be reviewed should there be any legislative changes that could impact upon it.



## Contact us

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